TransUnion Credit Score Fast Facts

Every credit active consumer has a credit report that is compiled by a credit bureau.

Your TransUnion Credit Score is essentially a “numerical summary” of your TransUnion credit report. All the credit information in your credit report contributes towards the calculation of your credit score.

Your TransUnion Credit Score is a number that indicates strengths and weaknesses of the information in your credit report. It shows you how you compare to other consumers when it comes to the way you manage your credit. Your score can improve or deteriorate, depending on your credit behaviour.

The TransUnion Credit Score is not an endorsement, or a condemnation, of you or your credit behaviour. It will not determine whether you quality for credit. That will depend on the credit or service provider’s own criteria. It will how ever give you a general indication of areas that you may need to improve if you want to qualify for credit.

The National Credit Act states that a credit or service provider may use its own scoring evaluative mechanism or model to determine who to give credit to. This means that the TransUnion Credit Score is not the same score that lenders will use to decide if you qualify for credit or a loan. The credit risk score used by lenders will include not only the credit information held by a credit bureau, but also information such as your income and living expenses, your demographic information, current and past relationship with the lender, collateral etc.

There is no single score or “scoring formula” that’s used all the time by all credit providers. The specific formula a lender chooses is beyond your control. What’s within your control is your ability to handle your credit obligations responsibly each month and take simple steps to keep yourself in good credit standing.

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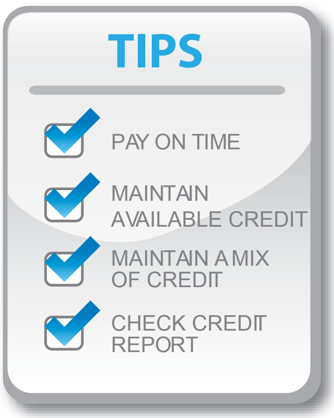
The following key factors make up your TransUnion Credit Score

1. **Payment history:** The way in which you manage your accounts – whether or not the full instalment is paid on time.
2. **Too much debt:** How much you owe and how much available credit is being used.
3. **Negative information:** Information such as bankruptcies and judgments on your credit record. These are items of public record that indicate that you did not honour a particular debt obligation.
4. **Length of credit history:** How long each account has been open.
5. **Number of new accounts and the number of account enquiries within a short timeframe:** How many new accounts are applied for and opened in a short period.

Tips to boost your TransUnion Credit Score:



1. **Pay the amount due** on every one of your account in full and on time, every time.
2. **Limit your utilisation of credit** – do not use all your available credit to the maximum allowed; manage your debts responsibly; and avoid applying for too much credit within a short timeframe.
3. **Maintain a healthy mix of credit** (store accounts, credit cards, home loan, service contracts such as cell phone accounts and so on) in order to establish a strong credit history.

Check your credit report - and your credit score - regularly to ensure each consistently paints you in the most accurate and positive light possible.

Get your Credit Score

www.mytransunion.co.za